

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

BEFORE THE SECRETARY OF AGRICULTURE

In re:

Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC
doing business as Branson's
Promised Land Zoo,

Respondent.

AWA Docket No. 25-J-0090

CONSENT DECISION AND ORDER

This proceeding was instituted under the Animal Welfare Act, as amended (7 U.S.C. § 2131 *et seq.*) ("AWA" or "Act"), by a complaint filed by the Administrator, Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service ("APHIS"), United States Department of Agriculture ("USDA"), alleging that the Respondent violated the Act, the regulations (9 C.F.R. Part 2) (Regulations), and the standards issued thereunder (9 C.F.R. Part 3) (Standards). This Consent Decision and Order is entered pursuant to the consent decision provisions of the Rules of Practice applicable to this proceeding (7 C.F.R. § 1.138).

Respondent Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC, doing business as Branson's Promised Land Zoo, admits the Findings of Fact, as set forth herein, neither admits nor denies the remaining allegations in the Complaint, and specifically admits that the Secretary of the Agriculture has jurisdiction in this matter. Respondent waives oral hearing and all further procedures to which Respondent may be entitled under the law; waives any and all rights or defenses the Respondent has or might have, including for this matter to be adjudicated in a federal district court in the first instance and any associated right to a jury trial; waives all rights to seek judicial review and otherwise challenge or contest the validity of this Consent Decision and Order, including waiving challenges to the Administrative Law Judge's authority to enter

this Consent Decision and Order under the Administrative Procedure Act and the Constitution of the United States; and waives any action against the USDA under the Equal Access to Justice Act of 1980 (5 U.S.C. § 504 *et seq.*) for fees and other expenses incurred by the Respondent in connection with this proceeding or any action against any USDA employee in his or her individual capacity in connection with this proceeding.

The parties consent and agree to the entry of this Consent Decision and Order for the purpose of settling this proceeding.

FINDINGS OF FACT

1. Respondent Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC, doing business as Branson's Promised Land Zoo, is registered in the state of Missouri and has a mailing address of 2751 Shepherd of the Hills Expressway, Branson, MO 65616.
2. Noah Sanders is the Director of Operations of the Respondent.
3. At all times material herein, the Respondent operated as an Exhibitor, as that term is defined in the Act, the Regulations, and the Standards.
4. At all times material herein, the Respondent possessed AWA Class C "Exhibitor" license No. 43-C-0352.

CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

Respondent Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC, doing business as Branson's Promised Land Zoo, having admitted the Findings of Fact, as set forth herein, and the parties having agreed to the entry of this Consent Decision and Order, such Consent Decision and Order shall be entered.

ORDER

1. Respondent Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC, doing business as Branson's Promised Land Zoo, and its agents and employees, successors and assigns, directly or through any corporate or other device, shall cease and desist from violating the Act, the Regulations, and the Standards.

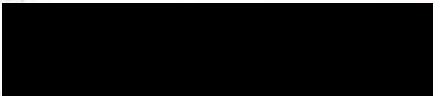
2. Respondent is assessed a civil penalty in the amount of five hundred dollars (\$500). Respondent shall have a maximum of thirty (30) days from the effective date of this Consent Decision and Order to pay the civil penalty. Respondent shall send a certified check or money order, made payable to the "Treasurer of the United States," to USDA APHIS GENERAL, P.O. Box 979043, St. Louis, MO 63197-9000. Respondent shall write the docket number of this proceeding on the certified check or money order.

3. This Consent Decision and Order shall have the same force and effect as if entered after full hearing.

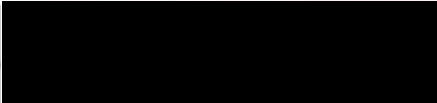
4. The provisions of this Consent Decision and Order shall become final and effective on the date of signature by the Administrative Law Judge.

5. Copies of this Consent Decision and Order shall be served upon the parties or their counsel.

By


Noah Sanders
Director of Operations
Promised Land Zoo Branson, LLC,
doing business as Branson's Promised Land Zoo

By



Attorney for the Respondent

Alexander Penalta, Esq., as General Counsel in
Florida and in the District of Columbia³
for The Cavalry Group (www.thecavalrygroup.com)

By: John Rodriguez
John Rodriguez
Attorney for the Complainant

Done at Washington, D.C.,
this 17th day of September 2025

By: CHANNING STROTHER
Channing D. Strother
Chief Administrative Law Judge

Digitally signed by
CHANNING STROTHER
Date: 2025.09.17 14:21:37
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